Learner Cancellation, Rescheduling and No-Show Policy

Mwalimu, operated by Oval Desk Ventures · Effective date: 1 November 2026 · Version 1.1

1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This policy sets the rules for cancellation, rescheduling, lateness and non-attendance of tuition sessions booked through Mwalimu.

1.2 Mwalimu supports advance bookings and on-demand bookings. Learners can book an available tutor for a session starting immediately, or within 20 minutes, 40 minutes, one hour, two hours or any later time. The policy therefore treats on-demand and scheduled bookings differently.

1.3 The objectives are to protect learners from unnecessary disruption, protect tutors from avoidable loss of teaching time, encourage punctuality and reliability, give transparent refund and rescheduling arrangements, and maintain confidence in Mwalimu's booking system.

1.4 This policy applies to individual tuition, group sessions and examination clinics. Sections 8 and 9 contain the rules specific to group sessions and clinics.

1.5 The applicable cancellation conditions are displayed to the learner before payment. All times are measured against the scheduled start time recorded on the Mwalimu platform.

2. Booking types

On-demand booking: a session starting immediately, or within two hours of booking confirmation (for example in 20 minutes, 40 minutes, one hour or two hours).

Scheduled booking: a session starting more than two hours after booking confirmation.

3. Cancelling an on-demand booking

Tutors make themselves available at short notice, so learners must decide quickly.

Circumstance	Treatment
Cancelled within 10 minutes of booking confirmation, before the tutor joins the classroom	Full refund
Cancelled more than 10 minutes after confirmation, before the tutor joins	Subject to review; no automatic refund
Cancelled after the tutor has joined and made themselves available	No automatic refund
Cancelled after the lesson has started	No refund
Learner fails to attend	Learner no-show; no refund

3.1 The 10-minute window lets a learner or parent correct an accidental booking or reconsider before the tutor commits time to the session.

3.2 Once the tutor has joined the virtual classroom, the booking is ordinarily treated as having commenced.

3.3 If the tutor fails to join within the grace period in section 6, section 7 applies and this section does not limit the learner's remedies.

4. Cancelling a scheduled booking

Time of cancellation before the lesson	Treatment
At least 1 hour	Full refund or free rescheduling
At least 30 minutes but less than 1 hour	50% refund, or rescheduling subject to tutor availability
Less than 30 minutes	No automatic refund
Learner fails to attend	Learner no-show; no refund

4.1 A learner may ask for an exception in genuine emergencies or circumstances beyond their reasonable control (section 10).

5. Rescheduling

5.1 An on-demand booking may be rescheduled only with the tutor's agreement and subject to availability.

5.2 A scheduled booking may be rescheduled without penalty if the request is made at least 1 hour before the lesson.

5.3 A request made less than 1 hour before the lesson is subject to tutor availability and the cancellation conditions in section 4.

5.4 A rescheduled lesson must be confirmed by both parties through Mwalimu or an officially recognised Mwalimu communication channel. A booking is not rescheduled until the new date and time are confirmed.

6. Lateness and learner no-shows

6.1 Learners and tutors are expected to join the virtual classroom at the scheduled time. The same grace period applies to both:

Session	Grace period
20-minute session	3 minutes
40-minute session	5 minutes
60-minute session, group session or examination clinic	10 minutes

6.2 During the grace period the tutor should remain available. If the learner has not joined when it ends and has not communicated, the tutor may report the learner as absent, and the booking may be treated as a learner no-show.

6.3 A learner who joins late is not entitled to an extension beyond the scheduled end time.

6.4 A learner no-show does not qualify for a refund unless Mwalimu approves an exception.

7. Tutor cancellations and tutor no-shows

7.1 If a tutor cancels a confirmed session, fails to join within the grace period, or cannot deliver the session, Mwalimu will notify the learner at once and make reasonable efforts to find an alternative tutor.

7.2 The learner may choose an alternative tutor, a reschedule, or a full refund.

7.3 Where a tutor joins late but within the session time, the tutor should deliver the full paid duration if the learner agrees and the schedule allows. If the full lesson cannot be delivered, the learner must be offered an appropriate replacement, credit or refund.

7.4 Tutor cancellations and no-shows are recorded and may lead to action under the Tutor Services Agreement.

8. Group sessions

Time of cancellation before the session	Treatment
At least 2 hours	Full refund, or transfer to another available session
At least 1 hour but less than 2 hours	50% refund, or transfer subject to availability
Less than 1 hour	No automatic refund

8.1 If Mwalimu cancels a group session, learners receive a full refund or a place in an alternative session.

8.2 If the tutor cancels, Mwalimu will try to arrange a replacement tutor or reschedule the session. A learner who does not accept the replacement or new time is entitled to a full refund.

9. Examination clinics

Clinics may need tutor preparation, materials and reserved capacity.

Time of cancellation before the clinic	Treatment
At least 2 hours	Full refund

Time of cancellation before the clinic	Treatment
At least 1 hour but less than 2 hours	50% refund
Less than 1 hour	No automatic refund

9.1 A transfer to another clinic may be permitted subject to availability and management approval.

9.2 If Mwalimu cancels a clinic, learners receive a full refund or a place in an alternative clinic.

9.3 If the tutor cancels a clinic, section 8.2 applies in the same way.

10. Technical difficulties and emergencies

10.1 **Learner-side problems.** The learner should tell Mwalimu or the tutor at once, and the tutor should allow reasonable time to reconnect. If the problem cannot be fixed, Mwalimu may approve a reschedule, a credit, or a partial or full refund, depending on the circumstances and how much of the lesson was delivered.

10.2 **Tutor-side problems.** The tutor must notify Mwalimu at once and make reasonable efforts to restore the connection. If the lesson cannot proceed or is substantially disrupted, the learner must be offered a replacement session or an appropriate refund.

10.3 **Mwalimu platform failure.** If a verified platform failure prevents a session from taking place, the learner is entitled to a full refund or a replacement session. The tutor is not penalised, and Mwalimu will tell both parties the outcome.

10.4 **Emergencies.** Mwalimu may make exceptions to this policy for medical emergencies, accidents, bereavement, serious family emergencies, major internet or electricity outages, and other circumstances reasonably beyond the affected person's control. The affected person should notify Mwalimu as soon as possible.

11. Refunds

11.1 Where a refund is approved, Mwalimu will verify the original transaction and ordinarily refund through the original payment channel, where supported.

11.2 Mwalimu aims to process approved refunds within five business days. Any payment-provider delay will be communicated to the customer.

11.3 A platform credit or replacement lesson may replace a monetary refund only if the learner or parent/guardian agrees, subject to applicable law.

11.4 All refunds are recorded and reconciled by the Accounts Officer.

12. Review requests and disputes

12.1 A learner, parent or tutor who disagrees with a cancellation decision may submit a review request within 48 hours of the incident, giving the booking reference, the lesson date and time, a description of the incident and any supporting evidence.

12.2 Mwalimu will review booking records, communication history, payment records and platform logs before deciding. Any tutor payout for the disputed session is held until the review is decided.

12.3 Disputes that are not about a cancellation decision follow the dispute process in Mwalimu's Terms of Service: good-faith discussion, then mediation if unresolved after 14 days, then the Kenyan courts.

13. Abuse of this policy

13.1 Mwalimu may review an account where there is evidence of repeated unjustified cancellations, false attendance or non-attendance claims, deliberate abuse of refund arrangements, repeated booking and cancelling to inconvenience tutors, or misrepresentation of technical problems.

13.2 Action may include warnings, booking restrictions, or suspension or termination of platform access, after a fair review.

14. Acceptance

14.1 By booking a session through Mwalimu, the learner and the parent or guardian accept the cancellation and rescheduling conditions that apply to that booking.

14.2 Where the learner is under 18, the booking and this acceptance must be made by, or with the authority of, a parent or guardian.

Parent / Guardian / Learner declaration

1. I confirm that I have read this whole policy and had the opportunity to save or download a copy.

2. I agree to be legally bound by this policy and all its terms.

Clicking below is my electronic acceptance and signature.

[Agree & Sign]